

AJAX

5.1 The spirit of AJAX

The basic spirit of AJAX is in making best use of technologies we already have, to make the web more responsive and interactive. All you need is a browser with JavaScript support which is essentially every browser out there. Unless someone has disabled JavaScript or is using a really old browser, you can be sure that your web site will work. However, this doesn't mean web sites no longer need to work towards ensuring compatibility with all browsers.

The internet is no longer a web of documents. It has now become an environment of inter-connected services. Your work is now independent of your desktop environment. Whether you're using Linux, Windows, or any other OS, all you need is a modern browser, and you can do the rest online.

Not convinced? Let's see, what all you can do online these days:

Store documents and files at: **box.net**, DropBoks, **acrobat.com**, Google Docs, etc.

Edit Documents at: Google Docs, buzzword, **zoho.com**, etc.

Store images at: Flickr, Photobucket, Picasa Web Albums, etc.

Edit Images at: **photoshop.com**, **picnik.com**, etc.

The list goes on...

If you search online you will quickly find an online replacement for almost everything you do offline. In fact these services are now open in such a way, that you can store your documents at **box.net** and open them at **zoho.com** without downloading them! Or store images at Picasa or Flickr and edit them using **photoshop.com**.

Today, entire operating systems are available online, for example GlideOS and eyeOS. These are online environments which allow you to do virtually everything, online. Instead of making your computer more and more portable, you can just make your environment more and more portable. No pen